

Lecture 38 — Past Perfect & Past Perfect Continuous

Past Perfect

Past Perfect Continuous

Since / For

Practice

MASTER CLASS

Lecture Focus

This lecture covers **Past Perfect** and **Past Perfect Continuous** with simple spoken-English logic, structures, examples, negative sentences, questions, WH-questions, **Since / For**, and practice.

1. English Thinking: Translation → Direct English

Translation Method

Beginning learners often think in the mother tongue first and then convert the thought into English.

Hindi thought → English

जाने → go | आने → come | बैठने → sit | बात करने → talk

Direct English

With enough vocabulary, repeated sentence practice, and speaking habits, familiar sentences start coming directly in English.

Example: *May I come in?* becomes automatic after repeated use.

Daily Routine Practice: I wake up early in the morning. Then I brush my teeth. Then I go for a walk. Then I have breakfast. Then I get ready. Then I go to school.

Key idea: Translation is a support at the beginning; repeated practice helps you develop the habit of thinking in English.

2. Tense Map: Where We Are

Time	Important Tenses Covered / Focus
Present	Present Indefinite, Present Continuous and other present forms
Past	Past Indefinite, Past Continuous; now Past Perfect & Past Perfect Continuous
Future	Future forms are introduced as the next major area of study

Lecture note: Past Perfect and Past Perfect Continuous are less common in everyday conversation, but knowing their logic is useful—especially for grammar and for describing one past event in relation to another.

3. Past Perfect

Meaning

For spoken understanding, think of Past Perfect as an action that had already **been completed in the past**.

“चुका था”

“कर लिया था”

Past completion

Structure: Subject + **had** + V3 + Object

Hindi Idea	English
वह इंदौर पहुँच चुका था।	He had reached Indore.
हम खाना खा चुके थे।	We had eaten food.
उसने मुझे सब बता दिया था।	He had told me everything.
उन्होंने पत्र पढ़ लिया था।	They had read the letter.
वह यह किताब पढ़ चुका था।	He had read this book.

Important: Past Perfect uses the same helping verb **had** with all subjects: I, you, he, she, it, we, they.

Past Perfect — Why V3?

The pattern is always **had + V3**. So verb forms are important.

V1	V2	V3
eat	ate	eaten
give	gave	given
tell	told	told
read	read	read
buy	bought	bought
sell	sold	sold

Pronunciation reminder: *read* has the same spelling in V1/V2/V3, but the pronunciation changes in the past: “reed” → “red”.

4. Past Perfect — Positive Practice

Hindi	English
मैंने खाना खा लिया था।	I had eaten food.
उन्होंने फिल्म देख ली थी।	They had watched the movie.
तुमने किताब पढ़ ली थी।	You had read the book.
हम दिल्ली पहुँच चुके थे।	We had reached Delhi.
उसने दरवाज़ा बंद कर दिया था।	He had closed the door.

5-sentence drill: Make each sentence using **Subject + had + V3 + Object**. First identify the subject; then choose the correct V3.

5. Past Perfect — Negative

Structure: Subject + had + **not** + V3 + Object

Hindi	English
मैंने अपना काम पूरा नहीं किया था।	I had not done my work.
बच्चों ने होमवर्क नहीं किया था।	The children had not done the homework.
पुलिस ने चोर को नहीं पकड़ा था।	The police had not caught the thief.
डॉक्टर ने मरीज की जाँच नहीं की थी।	The doctor had not checked the patient.
राहुल ने अपनी गाड़ी नहीं बेची थी।	Rahul had not sold his vehicle.

Pattern shortcut: बस **had** के बाद **not** लगा दो. Verb फिर भी V3 में रहेगा.

6. Past Perfect — Interrogative

Structure: Had + Subject + V3 + Object?

Hindi	English
क्या वह पहुँच चुका था?	Had he reached?
क्या उसने खाना खा लिया था?	Had he eaten the food?
क्या माँ ने खाना बनाया था?	Had Mother cooked the food?
क्या हमने सामान खरीद लिया था?	Had we bought the goods?
क्या राहुल ने गाड़ी बेच दी थी?	Had Rahul sold the vehicle?
क्या हम बारिश से पहले आ गए थे?	Had we come before the rain?
क्या उसने मुझे बुला लिया था?	Had he called me?

Interrogative Negative & WH Questions

Interrogative Negative

Had + Subject + not + V3 + Object?

Example: *Had he not finished the work?*

WH Question

WH-word + had + Subject + V3 + Object?

Example: *What had he done?*

7. Past Perfect vs Past Indefinite

The lecture notes that the same situation can sometimes be expressed in Past Indefinite without making the sentence grammatically impossible. The important learning goal here is to become comfortable with **different ways of expressing past events**.

Core distinction: Past Perfect is especially useful when a past action is being related to an earlier completed past action or when “already completed in the past” is the focus.

Timeline example:

First → The train had left.

Then → I reached the railway station.

As I reached the railway station, the train had gone.

8. Past Perfect Continuous

Meaning

Use it when an action **had been continuing for some time in the past**.

“रहा था + time”

Past duration

Continuing action

Structure: Subject + **had been** + V4/ING + Object + **since/for** + Time

Hindi	English
वह 2 घंटे से मोबाइल चला रहा था।	He had been using the mobile for 2 hours.
तुम 3 बजे से चिल्ला रहे थे।	You had been shouting since 3 o'clock.
हम दो वर्षों से इस घर में रह रहे थे।	We had been living in this house for 2 years.

9. Since vs For

Since = Starting Point

Use **since** when the beginning point is given.

since 3 o'clock
since Monday
since 3 April
since 2012
since morning

For = Duration

Use **for** when a period / length of time is given.

for 2 hours
for 4 days
for 5 months
for 10 years
for many days

Remember: Since = कब से / starting point For = कितने समय से / duration

10. Past Perfect Continuous — Positive Practice

Hindi	English
मैं 2 घंटे से अंग्रेज़ी पढ़ रहा था।	I had been learning English for 2 hours.
वह सुबह से खाना बना रही थी।	She had been cooking since morning.
वे कई दिनों से क्रिकेट खेल रहे थे।	They had been playing cricket for many days.
हम रात से बारिश का इंतज़ार कर रहे थे।	We had been waiting for the rain since night.
तुम दो साल से उस कंपनी में काम कर रहे थे।	You had been working in that company for two years.

11. Past Perfect Continuous — Negative

Structure: Subject + had + **not** + been + V4/ING + Object + since/for + Time

Hindi	English
बच्चे दोपहर से टीवी नहीं देख रहे थे।	The kids had not been watching TV since noon.
वह कई महीनों से नौकरी नहीं ढूँढ़ रहा था।	He had not been looking for a job for many months.
वे सुबह से स्कूल नहीं जा रहे थे।	They had not been going to school since morning.
हम सालों से इस घर में नहीं रह रहे थे।	We had not been living in this house for years.
वह एक घंटे से मुझसे बात नहीं कर रहा था।	He had not been talking to me for an hour.

Interrogative

Had + Subject + been + V4 + ...?

Had you been studying since morning?

Interrogative Negative

Had + Subject + not + been + V4 + ...?

Had he not been working for two years?

WH Question

WH-word + had + Subject + been + V4 + ...?

Since when had you been studying?

Useful WH phrase: “कब से?” → **Since when?**

12. Vocabulary from the Lecture

Word	Meaning / Use
anticipate	पूर्वानुमान लगाना, पहले से अंदाज़ा लगाना
submit	जमा करना
denote	किसी चीज़ का संकेत / संदर्भ देना
restructure	पुनर्गठन करना, फिर से बनाना
decode	किसी चीज़ का अर्थ / solution निकालना
deploy	तैनात करना, किसी चीज़ को किसी स्थान/कार्य के लिए लगाना
detect	पता लगाना, खोज निकालना
elevate	बढ़ाना, ऊँचा करना
visualize	मानसिक रूप से देखना / कल्पना करना
utilize	उपयोग करना

13. Practice — Do It Yourself

A. Past Perfect — Positive

- मैंने खाना खा लिया था।
- वे दिल्ली पहुँच चुके थे।
- उसने पत्र पढ़ लिया था।
- तुमने अपना काम पूरा कर लिया था।
- हमने फिल्म देख ली थी।

B. Past Perfect — Negative

- मैंने पानी नहीं पिया था।
- उसने काम पूरा नहीं किया था।
- उन्होंने मुझे नहीं बताया था।
- बच्चों ने होमवर्क नहीं किया था।
- राहुल ने गाड़ी नहीं बेची थी।

C. Past Perfect – Interrogative

1. क्या उसने खाना खा लिया था?
2. क्या तुमने किताब पढ़ ली थी?
3. क्या उन्होंने फिल्म देख ली थी?
4. क्या हम पहले पहुँच चुके थे?
5. क्या उसने मुझे बुला लिया था?

D. Past Perfect Continuous

1. मैं दो घंटे से पढ़ रहा था।
2. वह सुबह से खाना बना रही थी।
3. वे कई दिनों से खेल रहे थे।
4. हम रात से इंतज़ार कर रहे थे।
5. तुम दो साल से काम कर रहे थे।

14. Translation & Speaking Activity

Speak & Translate

पहले sentence का tense पहचानो → subject पहचानो → helping verb लगाओ → verb की सही form चुनो → time expression लगाओ.

Checklist	Question to Ask Yourself
1. Tense?	Past Perfect या Past Perfect Continuous?
2. Subject?	I / You / He / She / We / They?
3. Helping verb?	Past Perfect → had PPC → had been
4. Main verb?	Past Perfect → V3 PPC → V4/ING
5. Time?	Since = starting point For = duration

15. Master Revision

Past Perfect

had + V3
Past completion

Past Perfect Negative

had not + V3
Negative completion

Past Perfect Continuous

had been + V4/ING
Past duration

Concept	Formula	Signal
Past Perfect	S + had + V3 + O	चुका था / कर लिया था
Past Perfect Negative	S + had not + V3 + O	नहीं किया था
Past Perfect Question	Had + S + V3 + O?	क्या ... किया था?
Past Perfect Continuous	S + had been + V4 + O + since/for + time	रहा था + time
PPC Negative	S + had not been + V4 + O + since/for + time	नहीं रहा था + time

One-line memory: Had + V3 = past completion | Had been + V4 = past continuing action + duration.

16. Homework

Write and speak 10 sentences using Past Perfect and Past Perfect Continuous.

Mix positive, negative, interrogative and WH-question forms. Include both **since** and **for**.

